

journals on this site. These are very similar to blogs, where you write your experiences of life or just short stories to entertain yourself and others. There are no forums on this site, but the journal does make up for it, or rather, for the lack of it. We would say that this site is somewhat similar to Friendster and has features more basic than other sites, although, it does manage to beat Friendster.

5.7 OKCupid

OkCupid is a very interesting online social networking site that we would like to describe here. Cupid is the name of the Greek god of love, and the name of this site very aptly describes its purpose... This site is more suitable than the other sites described here for people who want to date more than make friends.

OkCupid is different from other sites both in purpose as well as its features. For instance, when you sign up for this site, you are greeted by a lady cartoon character called Inga. Inga first asks you to enter a screen name for yourself and enter your e-mail id. She then requests for further information such as your age and gender, on subsequent pages. Lastly, she asks you to write a short essay on yourself. Do these and you're in. The site does send an activation link, but that doesn't seem mandatory to continue using it. Here, you don't have to enter the plethora of personal details that other sites require you to, so you don't click on the "edit profile" link next (there isn't one anyway). The makers of this site have decided to cater to exclusive clientele—people who want romance in their lives more than friendship. So what you actually do is answer a whole lot of questions related to what you would be looking for in a significant other and also answer if you would expect your match to have a similar or dissimilar answer to those questions. Lastly, you specify what age group of people you are looking for, their "preferences" and their location. Once this is done, the site matches you with other members on the site so that you come to know who among the members your ideal dates are. There is provision to mark your favourite people on this site just like other sites. So, search away and match away.